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July 30, 2025

Dr. Victor Funes-Leal
University of Arkansas

RE: MS #25325, "Information Provision and Externalities: The Impact of Genomic Testing on the Dairy Industry"

Dear Dr. Funes-Leal:

Thank you very much for submitting your paper to the *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*. I have now received three reports for your manuscript. While the reviewers have major concerns, two of the three reviewers recommend that I give you a chance to revise and resubmit this article for publication in the AJAE. Given that, I am happy to give you that chance. See attached reviewers' comments.

Reviewer #1 had some trouble following the dairy science jargon and seeing the value of some of this material for an AJAE paper. This reviewer also has more significant concerns over misplaced comparison to Bt resistance and some of the econometrics. Reviewer #2 thinks that the paper seems more like an epidemiology or biostatistics paper and not an agricultural economics paper. Reviewer #3 has two main concerns that are more methodological in nature. One is that the treatment or intervention is not defined clearly enough and that the treatment and control groups may shift over time. Second is that the current conceptual framework in section 2 lacks enough intellectual merits to serve the empirical analysis well, especially that you suggested in the title and literature review sections that you attempted to explore the strategic actions of animal breeders and the coordination problem in the dairy genetics market.

Understand: This is a weak revise-and-resubmit offer that does not guarantee acceptance. It is simply an invitation to resubmit a revised version. It sometimes happens that reviewers discover something upon a second, post-revisions reading that they identify as a fatal flaw, which may ultimately lead to a rejection.

If you choose to revise and resubmit, please complete and submit the revised manuscript within six months. Please attach any appendices to the main manuscript in a single pdf so I only have one file to send the reviewers. Explain in a cover letter

to me how you have addressed the concerns raised during the review. In addition, prepare a pdf file of a detailed response to the reviewers' comments that can be forwarded to them while preserving your anonymity. It is most helpful if you explain exactly what changes you made (including quotes of new text) and exactly where those changes appear in the text. Please submit a separate response to each of the reviewers and upload the responses as separate .pdf files so that they can be forwarded with the manuscript to the reviewers.

When you complete the revision, you should resubmit it through the Editorial Express website, noting that it is an *American Journal of Agricultural Economics* resubmission and using the manuscript number given in this letter in the submission process.

Thank you for submitting your paper to the *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read 'Rodolfo M. Nayga, Jr.', written in dark ink.

Rodolfo M. Nayga, Jr.
Texas A&M University
Co-Editor, AJAE

